# Childhood Obesity and Early Prevention

**GS II**

- Childhood obesity occurs when excessive body fat begins affecting a child's health. **Unhealthy diets**, insufficient physical activity and daily habits can contribute to weight gain, increasing the likelihood that health problems will begin at younger ages.

- Excess body fat can increase the risk of **type 2 diabetes**, high blood pressure, abnormal blood lipids and fatty liver disease. These conditions may develop during childhood and create long-term health risks if not addressed early.

- India faces a **double burden of malnutrition**, where undernutrition and obesity exist simultaneously. This makes public health planning difficult because some children need better access to adequate nutrition while others need support to prevent unhealthy weight gain.

- Prevention requires coordinated action by families, schools and healthcare professionals. Healthier diets, regular physical activity and **behavioural support** should form the foundation, while medical treatment may be considered for adolescents with severe obesity and associated health conditions.

***Childhood obesity requires early prevention and family-centred care, while India's nutrition policies must address both inadequate nutrition and rising obesity-related health risks.***